

# OGD-017 — Semantic Evolution

**Status:** Foundational

**Authority:** Terminology

**Depends on:**

- OGD-000 through OGD-016
  - OCS-000 through OCS-032
  - OAS-000 through OAS-031
  - OIS-000 through OIS-019
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## Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional model governing the evolution of meaning within the Organodynamics corpus.

Concepts evolve.

Definitions evolve.

Relationships evolve.

The evolution of meaning SHALL itself become part of the constitutional record.

Semantic Evolution preserves not only what concepts mean today,

but also how their meanings have matured throughout the life of the discipline.

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## 1. Objective

The objective of Semantic Evolution is to preserve the continuity of constitutional understanding across successive generations of terminology.

Evolution SHALL strengthen understanding.

It SHALL never obscure historical meaning.

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## 2. Definition

Semantic Evolution is the observable progression of a canonical concept's meaning through constitutionally governed revision.

Evolution SHALL preserve:

Continuity.

Traceability.

Interpretability.

Compatibility.

Historical accountability.

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## 3. Evolution Events

Every semantic change SHALL generate an explicit Semantic Evolution Event.

An Evolution Event SHALL preserve:

Affected concept.

Previous definition.

Revised definition.

Reason for revision.

Applicable specifications.

Approval history.

Effective version.

Evolution SHALL become part of constitutional history.

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## 4. Categories of Evolution

Semantic evolution MAY include:

Clarification.

Refinement.

Expansion.

Restriction.

Separation.

Unification.

Deprecation.

Replacement.

Each category SHALL preserve explicit rationale.

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## 5. Compatibility

Every semantic evolution SHALL declare its compatibility characteristics.

Compatibility MAY be:

Fully compatible.

Interpretation compatible.

Migration required.

Historically incompatible.

Compatibility SHALL remain explicit.

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## 6. Cross-Specification Impact

Semantic evolution SHALL identify every affected specification.

Impact SHALL preserve:

Applicable sections.

Affected references.

Relationship changes.

Educational implications.

Cross-volume consistency.

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## 7. Machine Interpretability

Semantic Evolution SHOULD remain machine interpretable.

Machine-readable evolution SHALL preserve:

Canonical identifiers.

Version chronology.

Compatibility.

Relationship changes.

Reference history.

Machines SHALL reconstruct evolution.

They SHALL not reinterpret it.

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## 8. Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Continuity.

Historical traceability.

Compatibility correctness.

Relationship preservation.

Reference integrity.

Independent reproducibility.

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## 9. Semantic Evolution Test

Semantic Evolution satisfies this specification when independent readers can reconstruct the complete progression of a concept's constitutional meaning across every specification revision while preserving equivalent understanding of both historical and current usage.

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## Conformance

The Organodynamics corpus conforms to this specification when every semantic revision preserves historical continuity, explicit rationale, cross-specification consistency, compatibility guidance, and independently verifiable constitutional traceability.

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## Terminological Principle

Disciplines mature because their understanding matures.

The history of meaning is therefore part of the meaning itself.

Organodynamics preserves semantic evolution so that future generations inherit not only today's understanding,

but also the intellectual path that made today's understanding possible.

For a concept without history is only partially understood.

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**End of Specification OGD-017**